

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1543

By Bulso

A RESOLUTION to recognize Igor Babailov and celebrate his recent artistic achievements.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should honor and pay tribute to those uniquely gifted and talented citizens of this State, whose creative artistic genius has received international recognition; and

WHEREAS, Igor Babailov, a resident of Brentwood, is a world-renowned portrait and figurative artist, who has created portraits for Pope St. John Paul II, Pope Benedict XVI, and Pope Francis; and

WHEREAS, in 2010, Vatican Curator and scholar of Michelangelo, Monsignor Roberto Zagnoli, acknowledged Igor Babailov as Maestro when his Vatican portrait of Pope Benedict XVI was selected by the Pope for the Vatican Splendors international museum tour; and

WHEREAS, Igor Babailov was honored to be the only living artist in the exhibition, as his papal portrait hung alongside the works of Michelangelo, Bernini, Giotto, and other Great Masters of the Renaissance; and

WHEREAS, Igor Babailov has recently been commissioned to paint the portrait of His Holiness Pope Leo XIV; and

WHEREAS, Igor Babailov's iconic portrait of George Washington has been officially inducted into George Washington's Mount Vernon Museum; and

WHEREAS, in 2020, Igor Babailov and his family were granted Hereditary Nobility with the official Coat of Arms by Her Imperial Highness Grand Duchess Maria, Head of The Imperial House of Romanov, for Mr. Babailov's lifetime achievements and contributions in the arts; and

WHEREAS, in 2022, Igor Babailov was awarded the Ellis Island Medal of Honor, which ranks as one of the most prestigious awards in America, having been previously awarded to

eight U.S. Presidents, several Nobel Prize Laureates, and leaders in business, arts, and politics; and

WHEREAS, Igor Babailov has also painted portraits of, among others, President George W. Bush, Senator Marsha Blackburn, former First Lady Hillary R. Clinton, U.S. Supreme Court Justice Samuel A. Alito, President Vladimir Putin of Russia, Prime Minister Brian Mulroney, Prime Minister Jean Chretien, and sports legends Bobby Hull, Boomer Esiason, Tiki Barber, and Reggie Jackson; and

WHEREAS, a child prodigy, Igor Babailov painted his first portrait at the age of four and began his formal classical art training at the age of nine, the same age as Raphael, and has now created over 2,000 portraits and other works, more than half of which are in official public, private, and corporate collections around the world; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor Igor Babailov for a lifetime of achievement and world renown in the field of portrait and figurative artistry.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.